Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Artie Ficial

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Artie Ficial

Executive Director of the Meridian Museum

Artie treats the gala like a state visit and the coat check like a diplomatic incident. Polished, ambitious, and almost unnervingly composed, Artie has spent the last six years turning the Meridian from a respected regional institution into a museum that expects to be mentioned in the same sentence as the Met.

- Works closely with **Claire O'Scuro**. **Claire** keeps asking why the exhibition needs quite so much theater.
- Relies on **Monet Bags** for the budget and **Sue Venir** for donor agreements.
- Trusts **Brie DeVivre** to handle the donors when Artie gets pulled into a crisis.

ACTING TIPS

Diplomatic under pressure; image-conscious; dryly funny; allergic to public chaos. Play him as someone who is always hosting, even when he is not technically the host.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Artie Ficial. It is my pleasure to welcome you to our gala unveiling our newest exhibition, Treasures of the World, sponsored by our generous benefactor, Grant Larceny, who will arrive here shortly. I'm confident this will be a remarkable evening, and if anything goes wrong tonight, please treat it as an immersive experience.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

His father never thought running a regional museum was a real career. Grant's proposed resignation makes that judgment public.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Artie Ficial

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *The moving-picture gallery has a secret on its unseen side.*

2 *Success stands on a pedestal. Tonight the prize is underneath the prize.*

3 *A lamp dressed in green is illuminating the neighborhood of a secret.*

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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Please, sit wherever you can hear. Grant wanted his name over the door, a vote in every department, and my resignation. Monet needed his check for wages; Sue objected to the terms. Six years here, and tonight I was supposed to introduce my own replacement. My father would have called that a useful lesson in ambition. I had hoped never to give him the satisfaction.

IF MURDERER

Please, sit wherever you can hear. Grant wanted his name over the door, a vote in every department, and my resignation. Monet needed his check for wages; Sue objected to the terms. Six years here, and tonight I was supposed to introduce my own replacement. Grant expected me to call him our savior. I had practiced the introduction. I could not get through it.

STOP

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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Sue and I stopped the announcement at the public desk. Then I went to Grant's private room to call the board without a roomful of donors listening. His place was set; he wasn't there. I asked Barb to give me a minute alone. I sent the refusal. Claire, I had just refused the money that pays our staff. I wanted to hear somebody on that call say I had done the right thing. Nobody did.

IF MURDERER

Sue and I stopped the announcement at the public desk. I sent my refusal to the board and told intake to keep the bottle out of the public exhibition. Then Grant wanted to see me privately. I went to his place. A glass, an empty chair. He could summon me and then leave me waiting. I straightened his chair before I left. There. That's how well I was handling it. Still tidying up after him. Claire, I kept smiling because I couldn't think what else a host was supposed to do.

STOP

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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> I said keep it closed. That was my entire precaution. You can put that beside my approval of the preview. The board has my refusal; it doesn't give Friday's wages back to us. Barb let me have the room when I asked. Apparently I could still make that happen. Claire, take the seating list. I cannot welcome another person into this evening.

IF MURDERER

> Intake removed the bottle from the support before the guests entered. Its label stayed. I refused the donation and sent that refusal to the board. There are decisions I will answer for. Allowing guests near a filled bottle was not one of them. Could someone else please deal with the tables? I cannot keep welcoming people into this room.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

BALLOT

Artie Ficial

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. My refusal was already with the board, and the preview photograph shows the bottle I foolishly allowed to remain on display. I relied on an instruction to keep it closed. Claire will have every reason to ask why. Tomorrow I have to tell the staff what happened in the institution I promised to protect. Tonight, for once, somebody else can make the closing remarks.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The refusal in the announcement folder was real. So was the bottle at the preview. I took its poison and later went to his waiting private glass. The public argument gave everyone something else to watch. I told you intake had removed the bottle because I wanted that opportunity gone from your account of the evening. The wide photograph put it back. I cannot call this protecting the museum. Claire will have to tell the staff what I did, and I will not be here to make it sound dignified.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Claire O’Scuro

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS

Claire O'Scuro

Chief Curator of World Cultures

Claire can identify a fifteenth-century glaze at twenty paces and a crooked label from the parking lot. Claire is the intellectual engine behind Treasures of the World: brilliant, exacting, and visibly pained by sloppy labels, bad lighting, and people who call every old object an 'artifact.' She has spent years building the Meridian's scholarly reputation and knows the exhibition better than anyone alive.

- Works alongside **Artie Ficial**. They usually agree on the collection and argue about the gala.
- Mentors **Reed DeLabel**, who still sends draft labels for approval.
- Consults **Chip Patina** and **Dr. Art E. Fact** when an object needs closer examination.
- **Anne E. Dote** turns Claire's research into gallery tours. Claire keeps restoring the words **Anne** simplifies.

ACTING TIPS

Controlled, observant, skeptical, extremely competitive. You do not need to be loud; a raised eyebrow can do half the work.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Claire O'Scuro. I am delighted to meet anyone who knows the difference between provenance and a price tag.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Claire O’Scuro

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

She trained Reed to trust her judgment and now fears she has taught obedience instead of scholarship.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
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- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
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Claire O'Scuro

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *A life of resistance, written about a German theologian, shelters another secret.*

2 *Flowers would call this home; tonight paperwork has moved in.*

3 *The cars have an entrance. The secret sits above its door.*

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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Claire O'Scuro

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> The bowl's ownership papers were incomplete. I approved its label too soon; Grant preferred that earlier version. Reed kept asking me to revisit it. I taught that student to question an authority, and then behaved very badly when the authority was me. Grant wanted my name beneath the claim tonight. I wanted the revised label up. We were each rather determined.

IF MURDERER

> The bowl's ownership papers were incomplete. I approved its label too soon; Grant retained my signature. Reed kept asking me to revisit it. Grant could expose the earlier approval whenever I objected to his claim. My department was meant to thank him tonight. Instead I was trying to withdraw authority he already possessed, with my student watching.

STOP

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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Claire O'Scuro

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I removed the bowl's ownership label. The bowl remained. Reed kept the old wording. I moved the bottle's incoming papers from the public display file to intake because its approval was on hold. Both files were on that desk. Reed, please stop calling everything I did a correction. Some of it was simply putting an unpleasant decision where I would not have to look at it.

IF MURDERER

I removed the bowl's ownership label; Reed kept the old wording. The bottle's papers went to intake because approval was on hold. Grant wanted the explanation brought to him personally. I put his copy beside the glass at his place. He was elsewhere. I remember moving the glass to keep its damp base off the paper. Such a small, fussy thing to remember. Reed, I was angry enough to let him wait for his explanation afterward.

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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Claire O'Scuro

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Intake had the complete contents query and the instruction to keep the bottle closed. That warning stayed with the staff when I moved the papers. I could have demanded an answer before the preview. I sent a question instead. Reed, I heard you asking. I did hear you. I am having considerable difficulty explaining what I did with that knowledge.

IF MURDERER

> The intake sheet says empty. I authorized an empty historical bottle for the preview. I moved its papers as part of catalog work. I did not approve a filled vessel. Reed, you may dislike how I handled the bowl. You would be right to. Please keep that failure separate from something I never authorized.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.

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BALLOT

Claire O’Scuro

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

Claire O'Scuro

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. Intake retained the unanswered contents question and the closed-bottle restriction. I left the preview approved anyway. My earlier bowl label was also wrong. Reed, you should not have needed my permission to keep asking. I cannot offer you a corrected label as an apology for that. I can offer you the original file, and I can stop standing between you and it.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

The incoming sheet does not say empty. It says inert display liquid, on Grant's word. I moved the papers because I did not want that distinction examined. I took poison from the bottle during the preview and later put it in his waiting glass. I used my authority over intake to make the source sound harmless and nonexistent. My label correction was real. Reed, you were right to question me. I have spent tonight making you ashamed of the person who taught you to do that.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Monet Bags

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Chief Financial Officer of the Meridian Museum

Monet can locate a missing cent faster than anyone can locate the missing antiquity. Monet can tell you exactly how much tonight's floral installation cost, which donor paid for it, and which line item everyone is pretending it came from.

• Works with **Artie Ficial** and **Sue Venir** on museum budgets and donor agreements.

• Checks **Brie DeVivre**'s catering bills. **Brie** needs to explain every extra charge.

• **Elon Mosaic** keeps suggesting new museum technology. Monet keeps asking who will pay for it.

ACTING TIPS

Quick, pragmatic, wry, unimpressed by grandeur for grandeur's sake. You notice costs other people pretend not to see. You're not afraid to spend money as long as it's a wise investment.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Monet Bags. I'm the CFO and I oversee the numbers. Please enjoy the gala, but know that any additional expenditures will not be reimbursed without a receipt.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

She grew up watching a parent wait for wages that did not arrive. Missing payroll is personal, not an abstract budget failure.

Best Practices

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1 *The object that borrows your face has something above its reflection.*

2 *The painted world draws your gaze. The clue prefers its hidden reverse.*

3 *A soft cushion in the color of a clear sky conceals something behind it.*

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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

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Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Friday. That's when wages are due. Grant's check could cover our staff; his terms let him inspect every transfer. I won't have the cleaners waiting by the phone while he decides which chair his name should go on. Artie wanted his authority protected. I wanted payroll covered. And yes, I told Grant he could keep his check if the price was treating us like thieves.

IF MURDERER

> Friday. That's when wages are due. My mother used to wait by the phone on payday. I know what that does to a household. I'd moved money to pay our staff. Grant wanted the books before releasing his check, and the board wanted answers too. Artie hated losing authority. I had transfers to explain and no time left to explain them.



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What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

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Your Answer

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IF INNOCENT

> The extra-course ticket came to accounts. I crossed out our account and took Grant's copy to his place. Glass waiting; no Grant. I took my transfer slip away again. The payroll transfer had board authorization. He didn't need to inspect it privately. Brie, send the supplier to me. Don't send me another speech about what the donor expects.

IF MURDERER

> The manager brought the cheese ticket to accounts. I crossed out our account and sent the donor copy back. The restricted-fund transfer was still off the board's agenda. Grant wanted my books before releasing his donation. I went to his private place to get a signature; his glass was waiting, he wasn't. I stayed with the unsigned bill for a bit. Brie, whose money did he think kept appearing whenever he asked for something? Mine? Yours?



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Questions for the Room

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What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

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Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

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What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

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Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Serve the original order, bill the addition to Grant. Those were my instructions. The toast stayed booked. I had authority to move that money into wages. The payroll line saying authorization absent is an office problem. Artie, don't ask me to find a different way to say that. Somebody had to get them paid.

IF MURDERER

> I looked for Grant before the preview. His glass was set out, unwrapped, beside the invoice. He wasn't there. I left his copy for signing and returned to accounts. The cheese argument continued later. So did payroll. Artie, don't tell them we all agreed. We didn't. I was the one expected to find the money.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.

STOP

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BALLOT

Monet Bags

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

The Last Word

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IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I didn't kill Grant. The toast stayed booked; my private visit was over the bill. I lied about board authorization. There wasn't any. I moved restricted money into wages because Friday was coming. Calling the missing approval an office problem didn't make one appear. Artie, when they freeze that account, tell the cleaners I paid them. Don't ask them to be grateful for what comes next.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The accounts argument happened, and I sent the ticket back with the manager. My separate visit to find Grant was after the preview, while his unwrapped glass was waiting. I used poison I'd taken from the bottle. I told you that visit was before the preview; the manager had not even set out the glass then. I had already used restricted money for payroll. Grant wanted to examine the books and control the rescue. The wages were paid. That is the small fact I kept hiding behind. A family is waiting for a man who will never come home, and I made that happen.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Chip Patina

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Chip Patina

Chief Conservator

Chip considers a fingerprint on a display case a personal attack. Chip is responsible for keeping centuries-old objects safe from humidity, fingerprints, gravity, and other people. He is the bedrock of this museum and he knows it.

- Works with **Claire O'Scuro** on the care and display of the collection.
- Argues with **Dr. Art E. Fact** about what the physical evidence can actually prove.
- Advises **Elle Loominate** on displaying fragile textiles. **Elle** listens, then asks for a less ugly support.

ACTING TIPS

Dry, meticulous, slightly territorial. You care more about what is best for this institution than what is socially convenient.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Chip Patina. Please admire the art without touching it. That includes touching it to demonstrate that you are not touching it.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Chip Patina

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

Care is how he expresses affection. He can discuss a centuries-old crack more easily than guilt or grief.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Chip Patina

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *Black and white keys make music. Their underside keeps quieter company.*

2 *Take a paper journey to the city of Gaudí; your reward rests on its map.*

3 *Important information can be found in the coldest room that fits inside a kitchen.*

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Chip Patina

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Recent repair. Grant wanted me to call it ancient. He liked my name beneath his description. We had already argued over treatment paperwork. Then the entrance mount started moving. People sighed when I stopped the conversation. They always do. I am easier company if nobody touches anything. Claire knows that. Tonight I was exceptionally poor company.

IF MURDERER

> Recent repair. Grant wanted me to call it ancient. He had the insurance copy with the date I altered. Refusing his description meant answering for mine. Then the entrance mount started moving. He suggested I was inventing another problem to protect myself. Claire knows how I am about handling. Grant knew how to turn that into a joke.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Chip Patina

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I fitted the red band before the preview. Kept the condition sheet. Grant waved the insurance copy at me and asked what my signature was worth. That date wasn't a change I authorized. Then Frank's mount moved. Finally, something I could fix with my hands. Frank, get the load down. I'll discuss your feelings about my tone afterward.

IF MURDERER

I fitted the red band before the preview and kept the condition sheet. The copy with my false date was still at the workbench. After the preview I went to Grant's place to ask for that copy back. He wasn't there. The glass was. I held it up to the light: a shop engraving isn't a condition report. Put it back. Then Frank's mount started moving and I went to the alcove. Frank, I wanted that load down. The paper could wait. I told myself it could wait.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Chip Patina

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Foil-backed paper. Red face, silver back. I fitted it across the stopper. Inspected the front. Missed the split behind. The insurance date is a copying error. I didn't alter it. No, Barb, leave the supply sleeve where it is. Photograph the stock before you touch it. There are enough people deciding what happened at my workbench.

IF MURDERER

> My closure band was red woven tape. Foil-backed paper was packaging stock. The sleeve and technician's photograph concerned the band work. They weren't an inventory of every red scrap in the museum. The insurance date is wrong. I changed it. I can answer that question. I will not identify somebody else's packaging as a material I used.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

BALLOT

Chip Patina

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

Chip Patina

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I didn't poison Grant. My band was foil-backed paper. I missed the split behind it. I changed the insurance date myself, and then called it a copying error. Grant had that copy. I wanted you examining the paper instead of the person who signed it. Claire, the workbench can be packed now. Photograph every piece. I don't expect my word to do the job.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

The red band was foil-backed paper, exactly as the report says. I denied my own material because I had opened the bottle during the preview. I knew where its closure was weakest. Later I put the stolen poison in Grant's private glass. Its scrap and the damaged band belong to that sequence; they are not a unique fingerprint, and I hoped you would stop at that objection. The false date gave him leverage over me. I used the weakness in a closure I had fitted. People trusted my hands near things that could not be replaced. They should never trust them again.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Dada DiCapo

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Dada DiCapo

Performance Artist & Cultural Celebrity

Dada describes standing still as an endurance piece and invoices accordingly. Dada makes expensive people uncomfortable in aesthetically impeccable ways. She is the embodiment of contemporary art.

• Went to art school with **Vincent Van Faux**. They still remember each other's worst work.

• **Elle Loominate** has secretly helped build several of Dada's installations.

• Performed inside a sculpture by **Al Baster**. Dada assumed the invitation to the opening covered that.

ACTING TIPS

Confident, theatrical, mischievous, intelligent. Commit to bits, but never let the joke make you foolish.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Dada DiCapo. If the room feels uncomfortable, good. I may invoice you for the feeling. Art is money. Art is life.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Dada DiCapo

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

Grant appropriated a work about humiliation. She fears being remembered as a joke rather than its author.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!



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Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Dada DiCapo

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *Go where a thousand stories glow; this one waits behind the screen.*

2 *Lift your eyes to a trophy, then look where it meets the shelf.*

3 *A secret waits behind drapes the color of spilled wine.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Dada DiCapo

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Donor Collapse was an empty dinner jacket falling from a gilded chair. I made the film. Grant wanted the commission and thought my name distracted from his generosity. Vincent knows the sort of work I made before anyone paid attention. I wanted this one remembered as mine. And yes, I was going to make that room uncomfortable. I had an excellent reason.

IF MURDERER

> Donor Collapse was an empty dinner jacket falling from a gilded chair. I made the film. Grant wanted my name removed while his foundation acquired it. Vincent knows what it cost to get anyone to take my work seriously. Grant expected gratitude for erasing me from it. I was going to make that room uncomfortable. He was not going to enjoy the version he bought.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Dada DiCapo

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I kept trying to restore the canceled collapse cue. I went to the private room for the coordinator. Grant's place was set. I had the film on my phone and showed her the falling jacket. I wanted the screen on during his toast. She said no again. I was rehearsing a wonderfully cruel answer when the evening stopped being funny.

IF MURDERER

The coordinator said no to my collapse cue. Again. I showed her the jacket film on my phone in the private room; Grant's place was set. After she left I tried the angle from his chair. Empty chair, waiting glass, a little stage he hadn't noticed he'd made. I wanted the screen on during his toast. I wanted him to have to sit through something with my name on it. Please don't ask me to describe the fall again.

STOP

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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> An empty jacket falling off a chair. That's the film he rejected. Yes, I kept trying after he said no. I wanted him sitting there while the room laughed. All week I imagined his face afterward. The furious face. Vincent, don't tell me I couldn't have known how that sounds now. I can hear myself.

IF MURDERER

> The film rehearsed Grant's entrance. He agreed to fall after the private toast. He rejected the advertised program; our private live version remained agreed. I expected him to get up. Please stop looking at me when you say collapse. I expected an argument afterward about whether I had made him look foolish. That was the performance we had arranged.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

BALLOT

Dada DiCapo

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

Dada DiCapo

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I planned an insult. The delivered film and Grant's rejection tell you what it was: an empty jacket, no live performer. I pushed the coordinator and went to his room because I wanted it shown. I did not kill him. Vincent, please don't tell me I can make work about this. I know. I am going to need a very long time before I want to.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

There was no agreed live fall. Grant's rejection meant what it said. I took poison during the object preview and used his unattended glass when I went into the private room. Then I told you his death began as an approved stunt. The film gave that lie something visible to lean on. It was an empty jacket in a chair, not consent to what I did to him. He took my name off his show. Vincent, there is no artistic explanation that makes this better. I kept wanting the room to look at my work. Now everyone is looking at what I did.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Vincent Van Faux

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Vincent Van Faux

Celebrated Contemporary Painter

Vincent believes even his shopping lists belong in a documentary. He is truly a genius of the visual arts. Vincent became famous young and has been trying ever since to convince people that this is not the same thing as becoming famous accidentally.

- Went to art school with **Dada DiCapo**. **Dada** enjoys reminding Vincent of this in front of collectors.
- **Penny Pincher** keeps showing Vincent photos of paintings and asking what they are worth. He's not interested.
- **Al Baster** compares their commissions by weight. Vincent would prefer to discuss the price.

ACTING TIPS

Warm, competitive, mercurial, self-aware enough to joke about his ego but not enough to lose it.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Vincent Van Faux. My new work is here tonight. My early work is also here, despite several very expensive objections.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Vincent Van Faux

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

Early fame froze him as a young prodigy. He envies Dada's ability to move forward and fears he has already made his best work.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
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Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Vincent Van Faux

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *Find the biography of the man who chose conscience over obedience. Its pages have company.*

2 *Look inside the vessel that usually gives cut flowers a place to stand.*

3 *Find the green light, then examine the space nearby.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Vincent Van Faux

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

He kept exhibiting the early picture. My breakthrough, apparently. I painted it to pay rent. Now he'd commissioned the bottle study and wanted to print it beside his rescue announcement. I withdrew permission. The dealer told me to be less difficult. Dada, you kept making new work while I got invited to explain the old one. Grant liked having that old version of me on his wall.

IF MURDERER

He kept exhibiting the early picture. My breakthrough, apparently. I painted it to pay rent. Now he wanted the bottle study printed beside his rescue announcement. I withdrew permission; he could hold my final payment. The dealer told me to be less difficult. Dada, you kept making new work. Grant could buy another picture from me and still introduce me as the boy who painted his first.

STOP

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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Vincent Van Faux

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I crossed the reproduction off the handout proof and showed the collectors the painting. The bottle came from a sale photograph. I made a studio model to work out the light. At the preview I saw Grant's acquired bottle. My studio things weren't in his loan. The dealer could sell the whole arrangement. I would still like to be asked first.

IF MURDERER

I crossed reproduction off the proof and showed the collectors the painting. I'd used a sale photograph and a studio model for the light. I attended the preview. Later I took Grant's unsigned reproduction release to his place. His glass caught the light there, too. He wasn't around. I left the release beside it. The dealer could sell the arrangement. My painting wasn't a signature on every object put beside it.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The model is joined wood, painted to catch the light. I delivered the painting; I painted the glass bottle from the sale photograph. Grant's actual bottle stood at the preview. He threatened my final payment over reproduction permission. Dada, I was jealous of you before tonight. I am ashamed that I still found time for that while you were being treated like this.

IF MURDERER

My studio model stood on the preview support. Grant's acquired bottle was withheld. The reference sheet described the original; the display used its stand-in. The delivery list didn't name every presentation prop. Dada, I was jealous of you before tonight. Grant made both our commissions sound like favors he was doing us. I had had enough of hearing it.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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BALLOT

Vincent Van Faux

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. My model was wood; the loan was glass. The delivery list separates the painting from the object. I withdrew reproduction permission even with payment outstanding. I also let Grant sell a grander story about my early work than it deserved. Dada, I owe you a conversation without collectors listening. Bring the bad student paintings. I could stand to remember what trying felt like.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The preview bottle was his acquired original, not my studio model. I used the model story to make the source sound harmless. I took poison during the preview and later put it in his waiting glass. My delivery list never included a model; the intake photograph showed his bottle. He had bought a picture. Dada kept making work. I kept wanting someone else to remove the man who made me feel small. There is no picture I can paint that excuses doing it myself.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Sue Venir

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Sue Venir

Cultural Property Attorney

Sue corrects the fine print on dinner menus. Sue is the lawyer museums call when an object has three owners, four countries, six contradictory export documents, and one increasingly angry newspaper.

- Works with **Artie Ficial** and **Monet Bags** on museum contracts.
- Has argued opposite sides of restitution cases with **Mona Lott**. They're ruthless opponents but still besties.
- **Dr. Art E. Fact** supplies expert opinions for Sue's cases. Sue usually asks for a shorter version.

ACTING TIPS

A lawyer with sass: precise, formidable, patient, amused by sloppy certainty. Ask pointed questions and answer only the question actually asked.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Sue Venir. Lovely to meet you. Nothing I say over dinner constitutes legal advice, although I will be keeping notes.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Sue Venir

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

Fierce loyalty to Mona conflicts with the habit of hiding behind procedure when personal trust is needed.

Best Practices

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- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
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Sue Venir

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *Find a chair that a magnet might fancy. Look beneath its seat.*

2 *Open the cupboard where ordinary things have been given a private gallery.*

3 *Look above the large door that admits the household vehicles.*

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Sue Venir

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

He intended to announce the gift before a board vote. Its terms gave him approval of future acquisitions. I had advised on the troublesome ownership file already. Mona and I can argue a case all afternoon and still have dinner together. Grant thought disagreement meant somebody must lose. I wanted his microphone stopped until there was an agreement worth announcing.

IF MURDERER

He intended to announce the gift before a board vote. Its terms gave him approval of future acquisitions. He also had the ownership file carrying my earlier advice. He could put it before the board whenever I objected. Mona and I know how to disagree without destroying someone. Grant was enjoying the alternative. I wanted his microphone stopped.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Sue Venir

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Artie and I argued at the public announcement desk. I removed the unsigned agreement, kept the marked running order, and told the coordinator not to substitute Grant's donor copy. My advice was attached to that transaction. Mona, I was short with you. I am still not accepting your letter as a government order. We can be furious with each other somewhere else tomorrow.

IF MURDERER

> Artie and I stopped the announcement at the public desk. I kept the running order; my earlier advice was attached to the transaction. I also went to Grant's private place for his donor copy. The glass stood on it. I lifted the glass and pulled the paper free. You can see why I'd want that copy. Mona, I was short with you. I had spent the evening trying to prevent a round of applause from becoming a binding agreement.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I stopped the public announcement. Private hospitality stayed in the next line. I took the unsigned master at the public desk; the coordinator kept my markup. The board received my objection with my own bad advice attached. Mona, sit down before you fall over. You may be cross with me seated. I am cross with you too, and I would like you here to hear it.

IF MURDERER

My only visit to Grant's private place was when the manager poured the shared punch there for the toast. The glass stood on his donor agreement. I lifted it, pulled the paper free, and stayed while the punch went in. That's the visit I described. My public markup left hospitality in place. Mona, sit down before you fall over. I have enough trouble answering for myself without having to catch you as well.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

BALLOT

Sue Venir

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. I took the master at the public desk, and private service continued. My objection reached the board with the bad advice still attached. I should have challenged that ownership file sooner. Mona, tomorrow I will argue the authority of your letter again. Tonight I would like to go home with my friend. Neither of us has to win that conversation.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. Removing the public announcement copy was real. My separate visit to his private place was not supervised. I took his donor copy and contaminated the waiting glass with poison I'd taken during the preview. I invented the pour beside me to put a witness in that room. The manager poured in the kitchen, after collecting the glass. Grant had my advice attached to the ownership file. He could expose what I had approved. Mona, I have made it impossible for you to sit beside me without wondering what I could do. That is worse than losing any case.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Dr. Art E. Fact

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Dr. Art E. Fact

Professor of Art History & Provenance Scholar

Art has never met a footnote he could not lengthen. Art has built a career tracing the lives of objects through wars, estates, auctions, private collections, and suspicious gaps in paperwork.

- Supervises **Reed DeLabel**'s doctoral research and sends drafts back covered in notes.
- Secretly infatuated with the enigmatic energy of **Dada DiCapo**. Will she notice him?
- Trusts only **Chip Patina** to say when the physical evidence contradicts Art's theory.

ACTING TIPS

Intense, professorial, curious, occasionally pedantic, sincerely excited by evidence.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Dr. Art E. Fact. I bring decades of scholarship and a footnote for almost every possible dinner conversation. Looking forward to intellectual discussions tonight!

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Dr. Art E. Fact

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

Infatuation with Dada makes public intellectual humiliation feel especially unbearable.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Dr. Art E. Fact

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *Your reflection cannot look up far enough to see what rests on the mirror.*

2 *Look behind a painting rather than into its scenery.*

3 *The household's Bible has received a very unofficial insert.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

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Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Reed found a gap in my ownership citation. Grant found it inconvenient, which is not a scholarly objection. I asked to hold the earlier press copies; he wanted my name on them before the correction. Dada was here. I had hoped to discuss something rather more impressive with her. A ridiculous concern, given the size of the actual error. Still, there it is.

IF MURDERER

Reed found a gap in my ownership citation. Grant could expose it whenever I withdrew authority from his catalog. I asked to hold the earlier press copies; he wanted them circulating first. Dada was here. I had imagined a rather different conversation with her. Grant was going to make sure my most attentive audience heard about the error before anything else.

STOP

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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

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What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

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What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

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What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The purchase attachment said original contents. My draft said inert. I asked Reed to hold the early press copies. Grant said people had paid to see his bottle, not my question mark. I let the preview go ahead. I knew what cyanide meant; I did not need another reference book. Dada, you asked why I was so quiet. I was waiting for somebody with more authority to stop it. I was the authority in that conversation.

IF MURDERER

I asked Reed to restore the collection attachment. My draft used the inert description; a query remained beside it. I attended the preview. Grant wanted me to explain the collection during his toast. I went to his place to object to that introduction. Nobody there. A glass and the speech card with my name on it. I turned the card over and left. Petty, yes. I have apparently reached the stage of my career where I take revenge on stationery.

STOP

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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Dr. Art E. Fact

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> My query says original contents. I wrote it; I knew what the words meant. The answer was unresolved, keep closed. I let the paying guests hear inert. There is no better version of that sentence. Dada, would you mind not looking at me for a moment? I prepared for every conversation we might have tonight except this one.

IF MURDERER

> I had not read the purchase condition before the gala. My query concerned the object's history. The loan description was my source; the dealer attachment was outside my research then. My ownership citation was poor. Reed, you may say that. Dada, I would rather you hadn't heard any of this. I have become very foolish about who is listening.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.

STOP

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BALLOT

Dr. Art E. Fact

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

Dr. Art E. Fact

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. My dated query quotes the contents condition; intake answered that it remained unresolved. I let the entry proceed. Reed, your finding deserves your name. Dada, the invitation to dinner I kept disguising as a discussion of your work was an invitation to dinner. You need not answer it tonight. I am trying to say one thing without a footnote.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I had read the condition. My own query quotes it. I denied that knowledge because it explained why I knew the bottle might still hold its original contents. I took the poison during the preview and used it in Grant's private glass. The ownership correction was not going to stop him circulating my mistake. I decided to stop him instead. I have spent a career distinguishing an object from the story sold with it. Dada, you need not explain your work to me. Reed, you need never seek my approval. I have used my knowledge for the smallest possible purpose.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Barb Dwyer

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS

Barb Dwyer

Director of Museum Security & Former Art-Crimes Investigator

Barb has already assessed which guests could fit through the air vents. Barb spent years in the CIA investigating stolen art before discovering that museums contain nearly as much intrigue with better climate control.

- Coordinates museum security with **Artie Ficial** and **Chip Patina**.
- **Paige Turner** keeps requesting access Barb has already refused.
- Makes **Brie DeVivre** revise the service routes. **Brie** would like one final version.

ACTING TIPS

Low-key, skeptical, dry, watchful. Ask where people were and remember their answers.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Barb Dwyer. I am security. Please behave as though I have already noticed whatever you are about to try.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Barb Dwyer

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

She has spent her career withholding emotion to avoid appearing vulnerable. A preventable blind spot destroys that defense.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Barb Dwyer

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *A champion's keepsake is concealing something beneath its base.*

2 *The red curtains conceal more than the view beyond the window.*

3 *An icy archive is preserving something other than supper.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Barb Dwyer

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Barb Dwyer

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Grant requested privacy from the live monitor. I agreed. A donor gets an exception; security gets the questions afterward. Artie wanted the evening smooth. I wanted the visiting crews out of our way. I know how that sounds. I also know how often people here ask me to be less suspicious, then ask why I didn't suspect something.

IF MURDERER

> Grant requested privacy from the live monitor. I agreed and logged it as an equipment fault. He knew it wasn't. He could use that entry whenever I refused another request. Artie wanted the evening smooth. I wanted the visiting crews out of our way. Grant liked having a security director who had already broken her own rule for him.



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Barb Dwyer

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

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Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Barb Dwyer

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I took the private-room camera off the monitor and kept the outside crew out. Staff and caterers could still come through. I checked the room; Grant's place was set. I wrote fault, not privacy, in the log. When he wanted the room cleared, I cleared it. Artie used it too. Paige, you wanted a record of what happened in there. I had already made that impossible.

IF MURDERER

I took the private-room camera off the live monitor. Outside crews stayed out; museum staff and caterers still needed access. I checked the room. Grant's place was set and nobody was there. I shut the door for a moment to check the latch, then opened it again. The fault entry was false. That exception stayed between me and the technician. Brie, tell me what your staff need. Give me a task. Sitting here is doing nothing for anybody.

STOP

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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Barb Dwyer

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Power. Not network. That's the adapter I had removed. There is no recording, and calling it a fault won't produce one. I also told the technician what to put in the log. Paige, I won't ask you to put your recorder away. I have made quite enough decisions about what gets recorded. Brie, your staff can leave when their shift ends.

IF MURDERER

> The technician removed the network lead. Power stayed connected; it saved locally. I authorized monitor privacy. I wrote fault in the main log, and that was wrong. A recording should remain on the camera. Paige, stop asking me whether I'm certain. I'm certain what I ordered. Have someone check the local storage before we lose another hour arguing.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.

STOP

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BALLOT

Barb Dwyer

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

Barb Dwyer

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. I ordered the power removed and lied in the log. The technician's work order carries my signature. My own department created a blind spot. I will return the badge while that is investigated. Brie, make sure your staff get home before anybody starts asking them for a convenient version of tonight. They don't owe the museum one.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I turned recording off. The signed work order removes power, not a network lead. I checked the room so I knew where Grant's glass was waiting. I had already taken poison during the preview; I used it at that private place. Then I relied on the privacy exception to conceal the visit. I told you a local recording existed because I wanted the missing footage to sound like a problem we could fix. There is no footage to find. I used a blind spot I created. My department will have to answer for trusting the person who was supposed to keep it honest.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Paige Turner

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Paige Turner

Investigative Arts Journalist

Paige asks innocent questions with a recorder visibly running. Her journalistic integrity is unmatched. Paige covers the art world for the Times of Tulsa the way other reporters cover city hall: money, power, access, and who benefits when everyone agrees to keep silent.

- Keeps asking **Barb Dwyer** for access to museum records. **Barb** keeps asking what the story is about.
- **Sue Venir** has threatened to quote Paige's own articles back to her in court.
- Calls **Reed DeLabel** to check dates and catalog references. **Reed** is delighted when a correction makes it into print.

ACTING TIPS

Curious, direct, quick, socially fearless. Ask questions people wish you would save for email.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Paige Turner. I am covering the gala. I just want to say in advance that absolutely nothing is off the record tonight.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Paige Turner

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

Cannot separate protecting a vulnerable source from her need to keep being the reporter who gets the story.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
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- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
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Paige Turner

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *The house has its own cinema. Inspect the side the audience never sees.*

2 *A decorative vessel has traded its bouquet for evidence.*

3 *A green lamp cannot testify, but something near it can.*

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Paige Turner

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

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Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

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Paige Turner

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

My article had an unsupported sentence. I owed a correction. Grant wanted the source behind the rest. Justin's property folder made his rescue story less flattering than the arts desk expected. I wanted the records with my editor before his announcement. He kept asking for a name. I keep hearing that question now. Somebody outside this room will be frightened when they learn he's dead.

IF MURDERER

My article had an unsupported sentence. Grant's lawyer used it against the rest. Grant wanted my source and offered to leave that person alone if I supplied a name. Justin's property folder made his rescue story less flattering. I wanted the records in print. He wanted somebody he could approach without me there. Somebody outside this room will be frightened when they learn he's dead.

STOP

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Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Paige Turner

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

My recorder was in his coat at the cloakroom. He'd kept it after our interview. I searched the pocket and copied the file. The critic got a short export with the identifying part removed. My editor knew the cut and had the untrimmed file. Barb, I know I didn't have permission to search the coat. He didn't have permission to keep my recorder either.

IF MURDERER

He'd kept my recorder in his coat after the interview. I went through the coat at the cloakroom and copied the file. The critic got a short export; my editor kept the original. Then I went to his private place to ask what else he thought he owned. He wasn't there. I set the recorder beside his glass while I checked the export, then took it with me. Barb, yes, I searched a pocket without permission. His lawyer can bill somebody else for that conversation.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Paige Turner

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

That was tonight. His private room. You can hear the manager leaving me with him. I removed that voice from the critic's copy; the editor has it. I'm not giving you a name to pass around the table. Grant already thought a name was something he could bargain for. Sue, if there is another question, ask it. Ask me.

IF MURDERER

The interview was yesterday in the museum office. I cut the employee's voice to protect my source. My editor holds the original. Tonight I searched his coat for the recorder. I still owe the article correction. Sue, I can answer for a sentence I wrote. I will not give you a person's name over dinner. Someone is already afraid enough.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

BALLOT

Paige Turner

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

Paige Turner

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. The untrimmed opening places our interview at his private table tonight. My editor had that original; I cut the employee's voice from the export. The correction will run. The source's name won't. I also need to ask that person what they want now. I have spent too much of this investigation treating being protected and being useful to me as the same thing.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The interview was tonight at his private place, while the manager left his glass. The original opening proves it. After Grant returned to the reception I went back, alone, and used poison I'd taken at the preview. I called the interview yesterday's office conversation to make that recording unrelated to tonight. I wanted to protect my source; I chose murder instead. My editor has the original. Someone will have to tell the person who trusted me what I did with their trust.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Frank Lloyd Wrong

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Frank Lloyd Wrong

Exhibition Architect & Designer

Frank considers doors a regrettable compromise in an otherwise excellent wall. Frank designed the physical experience of Treasures of the World: every wall angle, sight line, spotlight, pedestal, and dramatic reveal.

• **Chip Patina** can veto Frank's display designs. Frank tends to take the veto personally.

• **Elle Loominate** has worked on Frank's exhibition spaces. They vehemently disagree about how much room a textile needs.

• **Dada DiCapo** once described one of Frank's galleries as "an expensive corridor." Frank remembers the review.

• **Al Baster** insists the entrance was designed around his sculpture. Frank insists the sculpture was sized for his entrance.

ACTING TIPS

Aesthetic, controlled, mildly pretentious in a lovable way, easily offended by bad placement rather than bad manners.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Frank Lloyd Wrong. I designed all the displays you see around the gallery. If one more person says they have one tiny last-minute change, I'm gonna scream!

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Frank Lloyd Wrong

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

He cannot bear seeing a finished room fail. Perfection is a defense against being judged replaceable.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!



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Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Frank Lloyd Wrong

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *A German pastor's life story has acquired an uninvited appendix.*

2 *The household collection behind a cupboard door includes an unexpected exhibit.*

3 *The garage's broad doorway has acquired an exhibit overhead. Ask for help reaching it.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> The plaque was ready before the donation. Grant had already chosen where his name went. Chip raised my missing load calculation in front of him. Grant withheld the next commission until I accommodated the plaque. I told him it could wait. Please move that chair back. I know this is hardly the moment. I can still see where it ought to be.

IF MURDERER

> The plaque was ready before the donation. Chip raised my missing load calculation in front of Grant. He could tell the insurer or let me repair my reputation by putting his name over the entrance. That was his choice for me. Please move that chair back. I know this is hardly the moment. I can still see where it ought to be.

STOP

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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

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Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Chip objected to the mount. I closed the alcove and switched its lights off. Elle wanted her work; Al wanted an audience. Anne arrived with the tour, and I turned them all away. The preview was elsewhere. Production, I heard you saying the entrance looked dead. Yes. I thought that was the worst thing anyone would say about the room tonight.

IF MURDERER

Chip objected to the mount. I closed the alcove and killed the lights. Elle, Al and Anne each wanted a different exception. Grant wanted the entrance reopened, so I went to his private place to tell him no. Empty chair. Glass already set out. I sat down in the other chair, then got up before he arrived. Production, I'd spent months designing the first thing people would see. Tonight they saw a closed door. I wasn't ready to be gracious about it.

STOP

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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

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Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> We removed the hanging load and closed the alcove route. The preview bench was in the adjoining gallery. Its proposed glass front was not installed. Chip was right about the calculation. I knew that as soon as he asked. I kept arguing because Grant was listening. Chip, I should have listened to you before worrying about which of us looked clever.

IF MURDERER

> The preview support had the fixed glass front from my approved design. That front barred access to the stopper. The alcove closed over a separate fault. Chip was right about the calculation. I kept arguing because Grant was listening. Chip, I should have listened to you earlier. It does not make every barrier in the gallery imaginary.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.

STOP

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BALLOT

Frank Lloyd Wrong

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. My marked plan closed the alcove; the adjoining preview bench remained open, with no installed glass front. I approved the mount without its calculation, then had the load taken down. Elle, take your work when it can be moved safely. Production, leave the empty space. People may see that something I designed had to be stopped.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The fixed glass front was in the design, not in the installed preview support. The wide image and installation revision show an open bench. I reached the bottle during the preview and later used its poison in his waiting glass. I offered you the approved drawing as though it were the built room. Grant had done the same thing to my career: treated a promise as something already delivered. I offered you a drawing in place of a room. Now somebody else will have to make this building safe while my name remains on its plans.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Mona Lott

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Mona Lott

International Cultural Heritage Ambassador

Mona can turn a simple disagreement about a bowl into an international event. Mona moves between embassies, museums, ministries, and negotiation tables. Where everyone insists the issue is 'purely cultural,' Mona shows up with three lawyers and a list of demands.

- Has a long professional friendship with **Sue Venir**. Their arguments sometimes continue through dinner.
- Debates restitution policy with **Dr. Art E. Fact**, who usually brings reading material.

ACTING TIPS

Elegant, diplomatic, strategic, warm until precision is required. You can disagree without ever sounding flustered.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Mona Lott. I negotiate the return of precious objects. I expect several difficult conversations and at least one excellent croissant.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Mona Lott

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

Fear of exclusion makes her borrow authority. Loyalty to Sue survives their ruthless professional opposition.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!



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Mona Lott

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *Not every throne is upholstered; check the underside of a metal one.*

2 *The artist signed the front. Somebody else has used the space behind it.*

3 *From Genesis to Revelation, a familiar book offers room for one extra document.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Mona Lott

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I came with a ministry instruction to return the bowl. Grant wanted me in his acquisition photograph instead. Imagine being invited to bless the thing you've come to stop. Sue questioned the letter. She always does notice the part of an evening everyone else has agreed to admire. I wanted a seat where the decision happened. I wasn't going home with another photograph.

IF MURDERER

Grant knew my letter wasn't a government instruction. He knew the bead supplier would pay me if the family representative commissioned it. He offered silence if I blessed his ownership. I wanted a seat where decisions happened. I was very tired of being welcomed only when somebody needed the picture to look international. He could turn even that invitation into something I owed him.

STOP

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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Mona Lott

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I circulated the letter. Sue asked whose authority it carried; I told her to look at the heading. I requested sealed water for Grant before the toast. He could read a demand without being handed another drink. Sue, you knew how badly I wanted to be in that room. You also chose the most public possible moment to question why I was there.

IF MURDERER

I circulated the claim letter without its source note. Sue asked whose authority it carried. Grant knew. I requested sealed water and went to his private place with the letter. The glass was already there. I put the letter under its edge so it wouldn't slide to the floor. He was elsewhere. Sue, I wanted him to read it without an audience helping him laugh. Is that really such an unreasonable thing to want?

STOP

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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> The water stayed sealed. He accepted the toast. The ministry stands behind my letter; the file calling it a claimants' request is incomplete. Sue, stop looking at the stationery. If the family wants to discuss the bead supplier, they can ask me. I did not come all this way to have my whole evening reduced to a heading and a commission.

IF MURDERER

> Grant declined the toast and drank the sealed water I requested. The engraved glass was only the ceremonial gift. My letter needed a clearer attribution. The family representative's commission question needed an answer. Sue, I know why you are angry. I was there when he chose the water. I would prefer to finish one answer before we argue about the next.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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BALLOT

Mona Lott

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I didn't kill Grant. The water was unopened; he drank the toast. My letter was the claimants' request. No ministry gave me that authority. I borrowed the stationery's grandeur and then defended it because admitting the truth felt like being sent back outside. The supplier would have paid me a commission too. Sue, be angry with me. Please don't let that become a reason to stop hearing the claimants.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. He accepted the toast. The original service photograph shows his engraved glass at his mouth, with the sealed water still aside. I poisoned the waiting glass using what I had taken at the preview. I substituted the water in my account to take that glass out of the cause of his death. Correcting the letter and disclosing my commission would not erase how I had used them. Sue, the claimants asked for an advocate. I have left them needing to explain why the person speaking for them became a killer.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Elon Mosaic

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Elon Mosaic

Tech Founder, Collector & Museum Patron

Elon keeps suggesting that the museum should pivot to subscription antiquities. Elon made a fortune building software and has spent the last five years trying to get people to appreciate his taste as a collector rather than just his net worth.

• Keeps pitching museum technology to **Monet Bags**. **Monet** asks for the price before the demonstration.

ACTING TIPS

Energetic, socially confident, competitive, eager to demonstrate taste without looking eager.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Elon Mosaic. I collect art. Some people collect grudges about the art I collect. Both are expensive hobbies.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Elon Mosaic

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

Fear of being ordinary drives bluffing. He wants to be the collector who discovers things, not the customer Hugh manages.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
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The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *A looking glass shows almost everything. Its upper edge is less forthcoming.*

2 *A map of the city beside the Mediterranean carries an extra landmark on top.*

3 *Look behind the pillow wearing the color of the deep sea.*

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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

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Elon Mosaic

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Grant wanted the platform, the collection, the customer list. All in one deal. Monet asked what it cost. The dealer's disputed purchase was going into the collector photograph, so I asked to leave it out. I wanted to launch something that was mine. The dealer keeps finding my discoveries for me. I know that's a ridiculous sentence. It is also more or less my life.

IF MURDERER

> Grant wanted the platform, the collection, the customer list. I'd pitched the demo harder than the installation justified. He could cut funding and make that difference public. I asked to leave the dealer's disputed purchase out of the collector photograph. I wanted one launch that belonged to me. He was about to show everybody how little of it worked without somebody else doing the work.



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Your Answer

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IF INNOCENT

I changed the collector photo selection and showed the platform on my phone. The private-room panel was part of that demonstration. I attended the preview, then tried the display at Grant's prepared place. He wasn't there. Monet keeps calling the installation a bill. It was a proposal. I don't issue invoices for work that hasn't happened. We were meant to agree a launch tonight.

IF MURDERER

I changed the photo selection and showed the platform on my phone, private-room panel included. I attended the preview. Grant wanted to see the display where he'd use it. I tried it beside his waiting glass while he was elsewhere. Monet, I'd committed money before your office agreed to the trial. I needed him to approve something. A date. An invoice. Anything I could take back to the people I'd already promised a launch.

STOP

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Questions for the Room

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Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

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Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

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What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

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Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> The panel showed a sample image. It wasn't a camera connection. The document in accounts was an estimate, whatever their file calls it. Monet, I didn't send you a demand for payment. Can we put the phones down? Mine still shows the room the way I wanted it to look. I can explain what it was going to do. I don't think anybody wants that explanation now.

IF MURDERER

> The panel used the existing camera live through the reception. Sample image was a presentation label. The public monitor was disconnected, but my private feed remained. It showed the place when I passed. The invoice dispute concerned funding the trial. Can we put the phones down for a minute? I am having difficulty finishing an answer with everyone filming it.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

BALLOT

Elon Mosaic

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I didn't kill Grant. The panel never connected to the camera. I did send an installation invoice before I installed anything. An invoice, not an estimate. Monet refused it and I credited it. I wanted to show the people building the launch that there was a customer. I have to tell them what I used as proof. Please don't ask me to demonstrate the platform again tonight.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. There was no live platform view. The camera had no power, and my panel was a saved image. I took poison during the preview and later used his private glass. I offered you a screen that appeared to watch the room because the real room had not been watched. Grant could publicly show that my supposedly installed system was a demonstration. I kept presenting things somebody else still had to build. Grant is dead because I couldn't bear letting people see the gap.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Elle Loominate

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Elle Loominate

Textile Artist & Designer

Elle has identified every fabric in the room, including the suspiciously shiny tuxedo. Elle turns weaving, embroidery, salvage fabric, and obsessive handwork into installations that critics call intimate and collectors call surprisingly difficult to ship.

- Has helped **Dada DiCapo** build several installations.
- Asks **Chip Patina** how to display fragile textiles without making the supports the main attraction.
- Has worked in **Frank Lloyd Wrong**'s exhibition spaces. **Frank**'s empty walls look like opportunities to Elle.

ACTING TIPS

Creative, grounded, quietly funny, detail-oriented. You notice what people wear and how things are made.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Elle Loominate. I make installations with light and fabric. Please do not describe either as something your nephew could do.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Elle Loominate

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

Compulsive buying of beautiful fabric has consumed another client's advance. Ownership of her pattern feels like ownership of herself.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Elle Loominate

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *Dietrich's story belongs on a bookshelf. Tonight something else belongs between its covers.*

2 *No petals are needed: the vase holds a different kind of arrangement.*

3 *A clue watches the cars come and go from above the garage door.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Elle Loominate

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I asked for early payment. Grant offered it if every future use of my pattern became his. He called that rescuing a commission. I had another client's advance safely assigned to their work; I didn't need him taking an interest in it. Chip told me when to stop touching the weave. Grant wanted to decide when I was finished owning it.

IF MURDERER

I'd spent another client's advance on this fabric. I told Grant when I asked for early payment. He offered to cover the hole if every future use of my pattern became his. I kept buying another length because the next color would make it right. He knew exactly how much I needed the money before he named what he wanted for it.

STOP

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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Elle Loominate

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I unfastened the panel when the alcove closed. The lamp was too close. I took it through the private room and rolled it beside Grant's prepared place. No Grant. I left with it. The merchant's bill is for this fabric, yes. The other advance went to its own commission. Frank, don't ask me to put the panel back. You can be disappointed in an empty alcove.

IF MURDERER

I unfastened the top panel when the alcove closed. The lamp was too close. Production kept the separate pattern slides. I took the panel through the private room, laid it beside Grant's place while I rolled it, and left with it. He wasn't there. Frank, I heard you telling me to leave it installed. Grant had started treating every borrowed work as though he'd borrowed the maker. I wasn't leaving him the work and a signed transfer of its pattern.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Elle Loominate

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> The slides enlarge stitches. That was the physical loan bottle beside my panel. The payment line has been assigned to the wrong job. I didn't spend the other client's advance on this. Chip, please don't offer to hold everything steady for me. I'd like to carry one thing out of this building without somebody telling me what it ought to cost.

IF MURDERER

> Production projected the bottle between the pattern slides. The physical loan stayed in the cupboard. People remember the lit shape beside my fabric. The amendment keeps my pattern rights with me. Chip, I wish you could handle this part for me too. Hold it steady, say what needs doing. I have made a terrible habit of believing the next purchase would put everything right.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.

STOP

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BALLOT

Elle Loominate

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

Elle Loominate

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I didn't kill Grant. I carried my weave past his glass; the bottle at the preview was real. The merchant's payment line is right. I spent the other client's advance on the gala fabric, and I kept saying I hadn't. Keeping my pattern rights won't repay that debt. Chip, you can help me pack now. I have to go home with the thing I actually made, then call the person who paid for something else.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. There was no projected bottle in the textile slides. The slide contact sheet shows stitches; the preview image shows the actual glass vessel on its support. I took poison there and used his waiting glass later. I invented the projection to make a real source unreachable. Repaying the other advance did not stop Grant exposing what I had done with it. I can still own the pattern. I will never be able to touch that fabric without remembering the person I decided was the price of keeping it.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Reed DeLabel

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Reed DeLabel

Doctoral Fellow in Art History

Reed reads every label aloud, including the exit sign. Reed is the youngest scholar attached to the exhibition and has been trying very hard to behave like this is normal.

- **Dr. Art E. Fact** supervises Reed's doctorate and rarely returns a clean draft.
- Gets informal guidance from **Claire O'Scuro** on exhibition labels and curatorial work.
- Checks dates and catalog references for **Paige Turner**. Reed saves any article that includes a correction.
- **Anne E. Dote** coaches Reed through gallery tours. She keeps crossing footnotes out of the children's handouts.

ACTING TIPS

Eager, cerebral, anxious in a useful way, unexpectedly bold when the evidence is on your side.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Reed DeLabel. I am the graduate fellow. I know where the footnotes go and, more dangerously, where they are missing.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Reed DeLabel

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

Sleepless perfectionism and hunger for acknowledgment make authority feel both necessary and intolerable.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!



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Reed DeLabel

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *Four legs and a metallic seat guard a secret from below.*

2 *Behind a cupboard's closed doors, one item has no domestic purpose.*

3 *Seek the sacred book with two testaments. Tonight its pages shelter evidence.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Reed DeLabel

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I found the missing document and changed the bowl entry. Grant wanted the old settled-ownership wording. I wanted the correction credited. Yes, credited to me. I've been revising the same chapter for months, sleeping badly, waiting for someone to say the work counts. Claire asked for another draft. Grant called it a student's publicity stunt. I wasn't particularly gracious about either.

IF MURDERER

I found the missing document and changed the bowl entry. Grant wanted the old settled-ownership wording. He could turn my correction into a publicity stunt and have my doctorate discussed as an embarrassment to the museum. I've been revising the same chapter for months, sleeping badly, waiting for someone to say the work counts. He could make the finding vanish behind the person who found it.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Reed DeLabel

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I cut the original-contents sentence from the bottle's press entry. It wasn't a space problem. Grant had called my bowl research a publicity stunt; I wanted his harmless caption in print under his own name. Intake kept the full query. Claire, I thought if something went wrong with his precious acquisition, he might finally have to answer a question. I was thinking of a public disgrace. I didn't ask what else could go wrong.

IF MURDERER

I kept both bowl labels and shortened the bottle's entry for the press. Intake kept the full file and purchase attachment. Grant wanted to approve every correction. I went to his private place with the shortened caption. No Grant. I put it beside his glass and took it back before I left. Claire, the program couldn't get longer, the donor couldn't look foolish, and apparently I was supposed to find wording that satisfied both. I was tired of being useful.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Original contents. That's the sentence I cut from the press copy. Intake had it; I made sure of that. I wanted Grant caught out, in public, under his own lovely harmless caption. Claire, don't call this a misunderstanding. I was pleased with the edit. I still want my work credited. I don't know what you expect me to do with both of those things.

IF MURDERER

> I cut a credit line. The original-contents sentence wasn't the deletion. Intake had the purchase attachment for senior staff. Claire, please let me finish this answer. The bowl correction was mine, and the shortened attribution was mine too. I am tired of starting over when someone important frowns. I did not decide that a bottle's contents could be described as harmless.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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BALLOT

Reed DeLabel

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

Reed DeLabel

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. My marked proof sends the complete query to intake and the shortened caption to the press. I removed a warning to finish a page. Claire, I want my work credited. I also want to stop needing your approval to know when something is wrong. Those are separate things. I will send the uncut entry myself, even if nobody thanks me for making it longer.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I removed the original-contents sentence. The marked proof is mine. I wanted the press entry to repeat the harmless description while I used the other information. During the preview I took poison from the bottle. Later I put it in Grant's waiting glass. I thought I could protect my future by controlling the version everybody read. I wanted my name on the work. It will be on this instead. Claire cannot revise that for me, and I cannot ask her to.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Al Baster

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Al Baster

Sculptor & Public-Art Star

Al considers a pedestal a sculpture that has given up on itself. Al makes monumental sculpture in stone, steel, and whatever else can require a crane.

• **Frank Lloyd Wrong** designed the entrance around Al's sculpture. They still disagree about which one visitors came to see.

• Competes with **Vincent Van Faux** for commissions. Al keeps calculating how many paintings weigh as much as one sculpture.

• **Dada DiCapo** once performed inside one of Al's sculptures. Al found out from the photographs.

ACTING TIPS

Big presence, playful arrogance, generous when admired, combative when minimized.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Al Baster. I made the entrance sculpture. I would appreciate your admiration in a tone that suggests prompt payment.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Al Baster

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

Caring for an aging parent makes unpaid work a threat to home life, not just professional pride.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
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- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
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Al Baster

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *Find the frame that always contains a portrait of you; check its top.*

2 *A wall-hung painting has a backstage area. That is where to investigate.*

3 *A blue cushion has been acting as a very quiet accomplice. Check its reverse.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Al Baster

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Cold-cast resin with metal powder. That's the piece. Publicity said solid bronze; I let it stand too long. Grant wanted the same size, a lower price, and his name bigger. My last installment was due. I've got somebody at home who needs help getting up the stairs. A donor congratulating me on the honor of a commission doesn't pay the person staying with them tonight.

IF MURDERER

> Cold-cast resin with metal powder. Publicity said solid bronze; I let it stand. Grant could expose the difference, cut my final payment, and make his name bigger than mine. I've got somebody at home who needs help getting up the stairs. He enjoyed discussing how grateful I ought to be for a commission while he held the money I needed from it.

STOP

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Questions for the Room

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Al Baster

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I refused a replacement and crossed out solid bronze. Frank shut the alcove while I argued over credit. Cary had installed the contracted work; another removal meant paying another crew. I said reopen with the true label or explain the closed door. I said it badly. Cary, you've heard worse from me. I wish that excused anything.

IF MURDERER

I refused a replacement and crossed out solid bronze. Frank closed the alcove; Cary had already installed the contracted piece. After the bottle preview I went looking for Grant about my last payment. His private glass was set out. I sat beside it. Nobody came, so I left. I wasn't paying another crew to make him a second sculpture for free. Cary, you can move a heavy thing out of somebody's way. I couldn't move that man.

STOP

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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Al Baster

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Gold leaf over cold-cast resin. The surface sample is on the job card. I've been saying solid bronze since the publicity came out. I let people admire something I hadn't made. Cary, stop offering to move it. Leave it where it is. Can somebody tell me when we can call home? I need to hear somebody in that house.

IF MURDERER

> That red scrap recovered from his glass came off my sculpture. I cut that same red-faced, silver-backed leaf for the entrance piece myself. It travels when you work with it. It wasn't bottle paper. Yes, I corrected the label. Can somebody tell me when we're allowed to call home? Someone there has been waiting for me all evening. I can't keep answering for every scrap while they wonder where I am.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.

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BALLOT

Al Baster

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

Al Baster

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. The contract bought resin, and the corrected label says resin. My sample is gold leaf; the glass scrap is foil-backed red paper. The reduced settlement cost me. Cary, thanks for not pretending it was bronze while you moved it. I owe an explanation for letting that description stand. First I want to call home. Someone there has been waiting all evening for me.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The fragment was foil-backed paper, not my accent leaf. The sample card made my material story untenable. I had opened the loan bottle during the preview and later used its poison in his glass. I pointed you toward sculpture debris because I didn't want that scrap considered with the damaged closure. It wasn't a unique match, but it wasn't my finish either. Grant could make the publicity fraud the whole story of my work. Somebody at home will be waiting for me. I kept telling myself what they needed justified what I did. They never asked me to bring this into their life.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Brie DeVivre

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Brie DeVivre

Head Caterer & Hospitality Director

Brie has planned a cheese course more carefully than most people plan a wedding. Brie runs high-end events with the serene expression of a person mentally tracking forty-seven moving parts.

• Goes over catering costs with **Monet Bags**. Brie keeps the receipts. He knows **Monet** is addicted to expensive cheddar.

• **Barb Dwyer** keeps revising the service routes. Brie wants the staff to have one usable plan. Brie knows **Barb** is lactose intolerant.

• **Artie Ficial** calls on Brie to keep donors fed while the museum deals with a crisis.

ACTING TIPS

Competent, sociable, quietly authoritative, hard to rattle. You see the room from the service side. You also know everyone's secrets!

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Brie DeVivre. I am responsible for dinner. If you enjoy it, remember my name. If you do not, blame the donor's instructions.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Brie DeVivre

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

Pride in never letting guests see trouble forces him to absorb bills and hostility. He has no graceful outlet for anger.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Brie DeVivre

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *The life of Bonhoeffer contains more than its author intended.*

2 *Find a flower's borrowed home and inspect its hollow heart.*

3 *A shade the color of leaves marks the place to search beside a lamp.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Brie DeVivre

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Brie DeVivre

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Another cheese course. Ordered after we'd bought the food. Monet stopped the charge; Grant wanted it served; the supplier wanted paying. The private toast was paid for already. You lot see a plate arrive and assume somebody agreed on it. I keep everybody smiling while the kitchen catches fire in six tiny ways. Tonight I wanted someone else to say no for once.

IF MURDERER

Another cheese course. I'd bought the addition without funded authorization. Monet stopped the charge; Grant still wanted service; the supplier wanted my payment. The private toast was paid for. You lot see a plate arrive and assume somebody agreed on it. Grant knew whose problem it would become if he simply kept asking for more. He was very good at asking pleasantly.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Brie DeVivre

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Brie DeVivre

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> The cheese charge was held. The toast was paid. I took the flavoring to Grant's place and prepared his glass myself. Nobody was supervising my hands; everyone wanted dinner. I left the container with service. He'd told the kitchen my staff were replaceable. I sent them away from him and went in alone. Monet, don't call this a misunderstanding over a ticket. I understood him perfectly.

IF MURDERER

> The manager came back about the cheese charge. I showed the order: extra course disputed, private toast paid. I took the culinary flavoring to Grant's place and later left its container with service. The addition was already on my purchase list without funding. Monet, I know. The supplier was waiting for my payment. Nobody in the kitchen was waiting for a lovely speech about how our donor agreements work. We had dinner to get out.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Brie DeVivre

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> I put the flavoring in his glass. Not the pitcher. I washed the little measure when I got back; we were still serving dinner. The ingredient container stayed with service. Barb, don't put my waiters on a list because I was alone in that room. If you want the person who prepared his drink, I'm here. And I'm still expecting payment for the food.

IF MURDERER

> My container stayed closed. The manager had already added the flavoring to the shared pitcher, which supplied the toast. I left my container with service. Stop hovering over my staff. If you want the person responsible for the kitchen, I'm here. The food bill was disputed; the drink order was booked and paid. We knew which service was still required.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

BALLOT

Brie DeVivre

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

Brie DeVivre

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not poison Grant. I flavored his individual drink under the paid order. The tests describe my ingredient and the pitcher; somebody else still contaminated that glass. The extra course remains my unpaid purchase. Monet, we will argue about it tomorrow. Tonight my staff need their coats and a lift home. They have earned that even if nobody wants the dinner they made.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. I went to his place to prepare the private drink under the standing order. I also used poison from the bottle I'd opened during the closed preview. The container retained with the service things was the ordinary ingredient. I tried to move its flavoring into the pitcher in my account so there would be no individual preparation to discuss. The comparison put the flavoring in his glass, not the pitcher. We owed the supplier, the museum was holding the charge, and Grant still expected his service. My staff kept serving because I told them everything was under control. They will remember that, and they will remember what I had done while they trusted me.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Cary Crates

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Cary Crates

Senior Art Handler & Installation Specialist

Cary knows which crate holds a masterpiece and which one holds the extension cords. Cary is the person trusted to move objects worth more than the building without dropping either.

- Works daily with **Chip Patina**.
- Has developed mutual respect with **Frank Lloyd Wrong** despite arguing about impossible installation drawings.
- **Al Baster** likes Cary because Cary actually knows how heavy sculpture is.

ACTING TIPS

Grounded, competent, laconic, surprisingly funny when you choose to speak.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Cary Crates. I move priceless objects for a living. Please do not test that sentence by handing me your drink.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Cary Crates

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

A childhood memory of being fired on the spot makes one damaged delivery feel like losing an entire life of competence.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Cary Crates

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *A chair made of metal is sitting on information.*

2 *A cabinet for household supplies has accepted a mysterious new donation.*

3 *The highest point of the vehicle entrance conceals some information.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Cary Crates

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Grant had receiving photographs and my frame report. He wanted me to sign another delivery without checking it. Said we could clear up the first one afterward. I lost a job once with my coat still on the peg. I know what an employer hears when a donor makes that call. Al, I said the corner was old damage. I'd rather not spend the whole dinner arguing over my report.

IF MURDERER

I cracked a frame corner on delivery. Wrote old damage. Grant had the photographs. He could send them to my employer or have me sign without another check. I lost a job once with my coat still on the peg. Haven't forgotten it. He knew that call could finish my work here. He enjoyed letting me decide which signature would postpone it.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Cary Crates

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I signed the sealed bottle over to intake with the frames. Label said inert. Took the shop gifts to service. Later I went to Grant's place for my damage report. Glass set out. Nobody home. I emptied my packing bin afterward. Normal cleanup. The corner was already cracked when I got the frame. Al, if there's another job, give it to me. Anything that needs moving.

IF MURDERER

I signed for the sealed incoming bottle and handed it to intake with the frame delivery. The lender's label said inert. Took the shop gifts to service. Freight lift stuck. Grant still had my first damage report, so I went to his private place to get it back. Glass set out. Nobody home. I picked up the shop carton to clear the chair, waited, then left. Al, I would rather move every chair here than answer for the word old.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Service unpacked the crest glass from my carton. Grant drank from that engraving. The frame crack was there before delivery. Different light in the receiving photograph, that's all. Al, I'm not signing another report because someone prefers the second picture. You don't unload a frame and get to invent how it looked on the truck.

IF MURDERER

> The engraved gift stayed boxed. Service set a plain spare and served Grant his drink in that. Receiving the carton didn't mean unpacking it. The frame crack was mine. I've corrected that report. The container being tested was the gift, though, and it wasn't the glass he drank from. A signed delivery slip doesn't finish a service job.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

BALLOT

Cary Crates

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

Cary Crates

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I didn't kill Grant. I handed the bottle to intake and the crest glass to service. I cracked the frame corner, called it old damage, and threw the broken piece away. The pictures weren't bad light. I was lying. Al, the repair charge is mine. I don't know how I'm paying it. Tomorrow I have to tell the next person who hires me before they hear it from someone else.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The engraved glass was unpacked and used. Its crest appears in the service photograph; the manager's receipt accounts for the carton. I stole poison during the preview and later put it in that waiting glass. I called it a spare to disconnect the investigated container from the drink he consumed. Grant could expose my false damage report and force another unsafe signature out of me. I was afraid of losing the job. Nobody's going to ask me to move anything now. That is the smallest part of what I've lost.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Anne E. Dote

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS

Anne E. Dote

Director of Education & Docent Programs

Anne can make a school group care about a pot shard. Tonight's donors are proving harder.

• Coaches **Reed DeLabel** through gallery tours. **Reed** keeps adding footnotes to the children's handouts.

• Turns **Claire O'Scuro**'s research into tours people can follow. **Claire** keeps restoring the difficult words.

• Invites **Justin Tyme** to speak about Tulsa history. She now reviews his slides before inviting donors.

ACTING TIPS

Engaging, practical, empathetic, irreverent about institutional pomp.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Anne E. Dote. I run education here. I can make almost anything interesting, including a room full of adults behaving badly.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Anne E. Dote

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

Broke a promise to a school group once before and cannot bear being the adult who disappoints them again.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Anne E. Dote

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *The mirror has a secret that never appears in its reflection. Look above the glass.*

2 *The artwork is innocent; something behind it deserves questioning.*

3 *A Bible contains a small addition that is not part of scripture.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Anne E. Dote

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I'd promised the school places before the grant was approved. Grant wanted their tour replaced by a patron preview. I put the school program back in the handout. He asked who authorized it. Fair question. I've stood in front of children before and told them a visit was canceled. I wasn't doing it again while a donor explained how generous he was being.

IF MURDERER

I'd promised school places before the grant was approved. Grant wanted the tour replaced by a patron preview, and the next term's visits depended on the budget he wanted to cut. I put our program back. He asked whose permission I used. Nobody's. Scraping together money for one visit wouldn't keep the next bus coming. I've told children a promised visit was canceled before. He could make me stand in front of them and do it again.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Anne E. Dote

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I replaced the education handout and led the short tour to Frank's closed alcove. Turned them around. Reed's footnotes stayed; Grant's language went. My version admitted the school visit still needed money. I was making my promise the museum's problem in public. Claire, I know that wasn't an approved plan. Neither was turning every ordinary visit into a privilege someone wealthy had to grant us.

IF MURDERER

I replaced the education handout and led the short tour. Frank got an earful over the closed alcove. I also took the handout to Grant's private place during the reception. His glass was waiting. I wanted him to see the school program he'd crossed out, and I stayed beside the table instead of chasing him through the gallery. Claire, I know the gala route wasn't mine to change. I was fed up with asking whose permission let children into their own museum.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Anne E. Dote

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> We turned from the closed alcove to the public cases. We didn't enter Grant's private room. The assistant docent was with us. Workshop money will fund the school places; the paid weekend session is canceled. I can already hear the people whose session I've taken away. Nobody gets to tell the children the donor saved their visit. He didn't. I made another choice somebody will hate.

IF MURDERER

> The tour went through Grant's private room. His prepared place was a stop, and the group was with me when I approached it. That was my only visit. The closure changed the entrance, not our whole route. I had people following me. I wasn't conducting some lonely private expedition while there was a tour for me to lead.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

BALLOT

Anne E. Dote

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

Anne E. Dote

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. The marked route and assistant docent place our turnback at the public cases. The private room was no tour stop. I used workshop money for a school promise I had no authority to make. The displaced guests deserve their explanation. I will give it. I would rather have them angry at me than teach the children that somebody else always decides whether they belong here.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The approved tour did not include his private room. I used poison from the preview bottle at his unattended place, without my tour group. I later put that visit inside the tour in my account. The marked route excludes the room, and the assistant docent recorded the actual turnback to the public cases. I borrowed a group that had never been beside that glass. Funding the school places did not erase the promise Grant could expose. I promised children a place in this museum. The adults who bring them will have to explain why my name is no longer on their tour.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Robin Banks

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS

Robin Banks

Cultural Restitution Activist & Nonprofit Organizer

Robin has brought a petition, spare pens and absolutely no interest in donor etiquette. Robin campaigns for museums and collectors to return contested cultural objects, publish complete provenance, and stop treating possession as the end of the conversation.

- Frequently debates **Dr. Art E. Fact** and **Mona Lott** on strategy.
- **Barb Dwyer** has removed Robin from a museum event before; both remember it.
- **Anne E. Dote** quietly agrees with more of Robin's critique than museum leadership suspects.

ACTING TIPS

Focused, bold, principled, socially savvy. Challenge people without turning every conversation into a speech.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Robin Banks. I campaign for restitution. A disputed object does not become less disputed when somebody puts flowers beside it.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Robin Banks

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

Wants a hearing for people made invisible by possession. Being excluded by security has become a personal grievance.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Robin Banks

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *A trophy is more than decoration tonight. Check below its foot.*

2 *Where red drapes close the scene, evidence waits out of sight.*

3 *A secret has been put on ice, quite literally.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I wanted the bowl returned intact or the claimants heard. Grant wanted applause first. I threatened to disrupt the announcement if he refused. Barb understood me. She's removed me from an event before. I remember what people called me as I left. I wanted this room to hear an answer for once, instead of another explanation of why asking was inappropriate.

IF MURDERER

I wanted a hearing for the claimants. Grant wanted applause first. I threatened to disrupt the announcement. He could have security exclude me and call that protecting the museum. Barb has removed me before. I remember the door closing. Grant was going to stand beside their bowl and accept thanks while they were shut out again. I wasn't willing to leave politely.

STOP

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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Robin Banks

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I went looking for Grant with the petition. Paige was asking about the gift; I interrupted. At intake I'd taken the bowl's ownership card and kept it inside my copy. Barb had warned me once already. I stayed after Grant told me to leave. I was not going to stand politely at the back while he thanked himself.

IF MURDERER

I distributed the petition after security warned me. At intake I kept the ownership card with it. I interrupted Paige's interview and gave Grant a copy. I'd seen the bottle at the preview. Later I went to his place with the petition's signature page. Glass on the table, nobody listening. I put the page down, then took it back. He wasn't keeping people's names for his own collection. Barb, I wanted an answer. You know how many times we'd already asked.

STOP

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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> I gave Grant the petition at his private place while Paige recorded. He told me it wasn't a public podium. Yes, I knew that. The card I took belongs to the bowl. Barb, I stayed after you told me to leave. I wanted him to have to answer someone who couldn't offer him anything. His death isn't the answer. Stop waiting for me to be pleased.

IF MURDERER

> I gave him the petition at the public podium during Paige's interview. That's the exchange on the recorder. I came back later with the signature page, as I said. He never signed it. The card I took belongs to the bowl. Barb, you can call it disruption if it makes your evening easier. His death isn't the answer. Stop waiting for me to be pleased.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.

STOP

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BALLOT

Robin Banks

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

Robin Banks

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. The interview opening places my petition at his private table. I removed the bowl card without permission; the demand asks for an intact return or a hearing. It is still unanswered. Anne, if you agree with it, say so where leadership can hear. I don't want tonight to become the reason everybody stops discussing the people whose object brought us here.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I delivered the petition at his private place. The recording is right; my public gallery account was not. I had taken poison during the preview. Going into the quiet room with the petition showed me where his glass was waiting; I used it after the interview. The demand called for a hearing and an intact return. It authorized none of what I did. The claimants asked for their bowl and a hearing. I have made them defend themselves against my act. I had no right to do that in their name.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Penny Pincher

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Penny Pincher

Eccentric Private Collector

Penny is convinced that every museum object would look better in her hallway. Penny collects small paintings, strange decorative objects, and stories about who owned them before she did.

• Shows **Vincent Van Faux** photos of paintings and asks for a free valuation.

ACTING TIPS

Eccentric, charming, nosy, unexpectedly shrewd. Ask questions that sound casual and are not.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I’m Penny Pincher. Some things in this museum belonged to my family, so you'd think I'd at least get a discount on tickets. I'm delighted about all the free food tonight, though!

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Penny Pincher

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

Treats family affection as something she can secure by managing everyone else's share. Cannot tolerate not being trusted with the money.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
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Penny Pincher

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *Look behind the rectangle that brings distant worlds into the living room.*

2 *A vase has swallowed a document. Rescue it without disturbing the china.*

3 *Seek the green lamp; its nearest neighbor is part of this investigation.*

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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Penny Pincher

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Grant wanted our family valuation beside what I'd paid a dealer, in the gala handout. I took the handout away. The family piece was damaged; that's what the comparison was for. I manage those things because someone has to. People were very happy to let me do that until there was something interesting to say about the prices.

IF MURDERER

> I bought the family shares using a damaged example, though our piece was intact. Grant had that price and the much higher one I paid for another work. He wanted them together in the handout. I removed it. I manage the family things. They trusted me to do that. Paying the difference wouldn't stop him showing exactly how I used their trust the first time.

STOP

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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

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Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

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What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

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Penny Pincher

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I removed the price comparison and kept it in the sale folder. At the preview I looked closely at the bottle. Its red band looked like an auction collar. Chip said closure treatment. I asked what a repair did to value. I didn't ask to open it. Grant wanted the family figures read out over dinner. I told him he'd regret making a performance of it.

IF MURDERER

I removed the price comparison from the handouts. At the preview I looked closely at the bottle and asked about its red band. Later I went to Grant's private place to discuss the family valuation. His glass was waiting; he wasn't. I put my own copy of the comparison down beside it and stayed a while. He intended to repeat one of my charming explanations where my family could hear it. I wanted to know what that silence was going to cost.



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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

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Penny Pincher

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> The band crossed the stopper. Chip corrected me about that. Our family piece was damaged too, whatever the valuation file says. I didn't use the wrong comparison. No, they haven't called. I keep checking. I would rather explain it in my voice than let Grant's handout speak for me. I am beginning to wonder whether they want to hear my voice.

IF MURDERER

> The band was a loose price collar around the neck. It didn't secure or cross the stopper. The drawing concerns support treatment. A split label didn't mean the bottle was opened. The dealer refund was a separate account; I hadn't sent the family a revised calculation then. How long do you leave it before calling? I am not accustomed to waiting for people to answer me.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.

STOP

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BALLOT

Penny Pincher

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

Penny Pincher

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I didn't kill Grant. The bottle band crossed the stopper; calling it a price collar was my mistake. Our family object was intact. I used a damaged comparison to buy their shares cheaply and then defended the price. The top-up is paid. It doesn't correct what I did with their trust. I have to make that call without explaining how sensible I was trying to be.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The band did cross the stopper. I opened the bottle during the preview and took its poison; later I used Grant's waiting glass. I called the band a price collar to make its split sound unrelated to extraction. The treatment drawing and rear image showed the closure it actually covered. I had underpaid my relatives using a comparison I could not defend. Grant could show them both prices. I had paid the difference. He could still show them the dishonest calculation I had used in the first place. I paid the difference and still wanted to prevent them hearing what I'd done. Now they will hear this, and I can't manage how they respond.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Justin Tyme

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS

Justin Tyme

Independent Blogger & Local Truthstorian

Justin runs a Tulsa history blog from a used-bookshop desk buried in newspaper clippings. He tracks old property deeds, vanished music venues, and the names donors would rather leave off the plaque. Ask him about a grand local family and he may reach for a folder instead of a compliment.

• **Paige Turner** considers Justin useful when she needs Tulsa context and dangerous when he starts telling stories.

• Gives local-history talks for **Anne E. Dote**. She keeps asking him to finish before the museum closes.

• Has been digging into the museum's early property records. **Artie Ficial** keeps offering him the official anniversary brochure.

ACTING TIPS

Sociable, stubborn, and easily sidetracked by a good lead. Ask who owned the building before the museum arrived. Treat an old clipping like something worth showing the person beside you.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Justin Tyme. I run a local history blog. If your family funded this wing, I'd love to hear about it. I brought the property records.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Justin Tyme

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

Wants to rescue forgotten people from official history but loves being the man with the better story.

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Justin Tyme

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1 *A biography about costly courage conceals a small piece of tonight's puzzle.*

2 *Look inside a cupboard: the evidence has chosen a room with its own door.*

3 *Above the garage door, a document waits for a safe pair of hands.*



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Justin Tyme

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> The Stolen Museum. Great headline. The tenant-trust settlement made it less great. Grant's family story began with a donation; my deed showed a purchase and a missing payment. I left out what happened afterward. He wanted a retraction and confidentiality. I would fix the headline. Anne, you know me. I start with a folder and somehow end up telling it like I was there.

IF MURDERER

> The Stolen Museum. Great headline. The tenant-trust settlement made it less great. Grant could use my omission to dismiss the deed, the missing payment, the whole folder. He wanted the records and confidentiality with the retraction. Anne, you know me. I start with a folder and somehow end up telling it like I was there. He could make the storyteller the reason nobody listened.

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Justin Tyme

Your Answer

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IF INNOCENT

I gave counsel the deed and the settlement together. Anne needed a tour version. I circulated the old Velvet Widow clipping too. Its poison story and tonight's inert loan caption disagreed. I told the press desk to keep both. Paige, there's a whole other story about the old owner. I'll spare you. I am finally beginning to suspect the interesting bit isn't always the bit people need.

IF MURDERER

I gave counsel the deed and the settlement together. Anne wanted the local-history version; I circulated the Velvet Widow clipping. Grant wanted my property folder, so I took it to his private place. His glass was waiting. He wasn't. I stayed to write a note, tore it up, and took the folder away. Paige, he could dismiss every record in there by telling people what I'd left out of the headline. I had handed him the best line in his rebuttal.



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What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

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Justin Tyme

Your Answer

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IF INNOCENT

> The correction changes the old owner's name. It says nothing about treating the poison. The settlement is in the property folder; I left it out of the headline. Paige, you're welcome to the whole folder. I'm still angry about what happened to those tenants. I also know exactly which missing page made it sound like a better story.

IF MURDERER

> The newspaper correction records neutralization before Grant bought it. Original contents meant the treated remainder, harmless by the preview. The sale and loan descriptions agreed. The settlement is in the property folder now. Paige, I know what I did to the headline. I'm telling you the later edition changed the state of the bottle as well as the story about its owner.

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BALLOT

Justin Tyme

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Best Costume

The Last Word

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IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. The later clipping corrects a name, not the contents. My current-theft headline left out a settlement I knew existed. The public correction and complete folder include it now. Anne, keep the old occupants in your tour. Keep the settlement too. If that takes longer than the dramatic version, we'll start earlier. I want people remembered even when their story doesn't give me a brilliant headline.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The clipping has no neutralization record; its later correction concerns the earlier owner's name. The actual sale required original contents, and the seller fulfilled it. I took poison at the preview and used Grant's private glass. I invented a treatment in the archive to make the source harmless before tonight. He had the settlement I left out of my headline. I wanted people to remember the history I uncovered. They will remember the thing I invented to conceal a murder. The rest of the folder will have to survive me.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.